

MindBridge

Customer & MVP Blueprint

"Democratising access to evidence-based mental healthcare through AI-assisted psychometric assessment and on-demand licensed therapy."

Field	Detail
Report Type	Customer & MVP Blueprint
Startup	MindBridge — AI-Powered Mental Health Platform
Stage	Side Project / Early Exploration
Sector	Mental Health Tech (MedTech / AI / SaaS)
Geography	Global (Primary: India, USA, UK, SEA)
Date	June 23, 2026
Version	v1.0 — Confidential

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Category	Summary
Startup Idea	AI-powered mental health platform combining validated psychometric assessments with on-demand licensed therapy sessions.
Problem	1-in-8 people globally live with a mental health disorder; 75%+ treatment gap in developing markets. Barriers: cost, stigma, wait times, lack of self-awareness.
Target Customers	Young adults 18–28 (India/UK/USA), burnt-out professionals 28–40, HR leaders (B2B), South Asian diaspora communities.
Core Differentiator	AI triage + validated psychometrics (PHQ-9, GAD-7) + affordable licensed therapy in one seamless platform — no competitor does all three.
Market Opportunity	TAM \$600B (2030); SAM \$42B; SOM \$180M by Year 5 at 0.4% SAM capture.
Overall Viability	7.4 / 10 — GO (Conditional). Strong demand signal, regulated domain, requires clinical + legal foundation before launch.

Core Value Proposition Pillars

Pillar	Description	Differentiator
AI Psychometrics	PHQ-9, GAD-7, DASS via conversational AI	Real-time scoring + personalised insights
On-Demand Therapy	Licensed psychologists — chat / video	AI pre-screening reduces therapist time waste
Affordability	Tiered: free assessment → paid sessions → B2B	Lower CAC via AI triage funnel
Stigma Reduction	Anonymous onboarding, non-clinical UX language	Removes social barriers to first contact

02 IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

Segment	Age	Geography	Occupation	WTP	Pain Summary
ICP A Struggling Young Adult	18–28	India, UK, USA	Student / Early-career	Free – INR 500/session	Anxiety, depression, loneliness, academic/work pressure. Can't afford therapy. Fears parental judgement.
ICP B Burnt-Out Professional	28–40	India, USA, UAE	Mid-level corporate	INR 800–2,000/session	Burnout, imposter syndrome, relationship stress. Has income but no time. Needs flexible scheduling.
ICP C HR / People Ops Leader	30–50	India, UK, USA	HR Manager / People Ops	INR 100–200/emp/month (B2B)	Employee attrition from burnout. Needs credible, scalable wellness with measurable outcomes.
ICP D Diaspora Community Member	22–45	UK, USA, CA, AU	Indian/South Asian immigrant	\$50–\$150/month	Cultural disconnect, loneliness, identity issues. Wants culturally aware therapists.

Prioritisation Strategy: Start with ICP A (trust + volume) → ICP B (early revenue) → ICP C by Month 12 (B2B unit economics for fundraising).

03 PRIMARY BUYER PERSONA

Dimension	Detail
Name	Priya — The Anxious Achiever
Age / Gender	24 / Female
Location	Bengaluru, India
Occupation	Software Engineer, 2 years experience
Income	INR 8–14 LPA
Devices	Android smartphone + laptop
Social Media	Instagram, Reddit (r/india, r/mentalhealth), LinkedIn
Goals	Perform well at work. Make family proud. Build a healthy social life.
Frustrations	Anxious every Sunday night. Can't sleep. Googled 'am I depressed' but felt overwhelmed by results.
WTP	INR 300–600/session if she trusts the platform and knows it's private.
Discovery	Instagram Reels, Reddit posts, word-of-mouth from peers.
Key Objection	'What if someone sees? Will this go on my record? Is this even real therapy?'

Dimension	Detail
Buying Trigger	Panic attack at work → friend mentions MindBridge → takes free anxiety test → result confirms mild anxiety → books intro call.

04 TOP 10 CUSTOMER PAIN POINTS

#	Pain Point	Severity	Detail
1	Can't afford private therapy	10/10	INR 2,000+/session in India — prohibitive for most young adults.
2	Don't know if their pain is 'real'	9/10	Lack of clinical literacy; dismiss symptoms as weakness or laziness.
3	Fear of being labelled / stigma	9/10	'Log kya kahenge' — family, community, employer judgement.
4	No one to talk to at 2am	8/10	Mental health crises don't follow office hours; need async AI support.
5	Therapist doesn't get their culture	7/10	Western-trained therapists miss nuances for South Asian clients.
6	Long wait times / unavailability	7/10	Finding + booking a good therapist can take weeks, killing momentum.
7	Accessibility — no nearby provider	8/10	<1 psychiatrist per 100,000 people in India (WHO 2023).
8	Generation gap / no family support	7/10	Parents in collectivist cultures dismiss mental health concerns.
9	Privacy / data security fears	8/10	Worry that employers or family will find out about therapy use.
10	NHS / public waitlist fatigue	7/10	UK NHS averages 18+ weeks for talking therapy — crisis point passes.

05 CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

Stage	Actions	Touchpoint	Key Question	Anxiety
AWARENESS	Sees IG Reel. Googles symptoms. Finds MindBridge via SEO.	Instagram, Google, Reddit	Am I normal? Is this serious?	HIGH
CONSIDERATION	Takes free PHQ-9 test. Gets scored result. Reads therapist profiles.	App / Website	Is this platform legit? Are therapists real?	MEDIUM
DECISION	Books free 20-min intro call. Talks to therapist. Feels heard.	In-App Booking	Will this help me? Is it private?	LOW
ONBOARDING	Completes intake form. Matched to therapist. First paid session.	App Flow	How does this work? What's next?	LOW
RETENTION	Weekly sessions. AI progress tracking. Milestone badges. Community.	App / Email / Push	Am I improving? Is it worth it?	MEDIUM
ADVOCACY	Shares on Reddit/Instagram. Refers 2 friends. Leaves 5-star review.	Social / Word of Mouth	Can I help others feel this way?	LOW

06 KEY OBJECTIONS & BUYING TRIGGERS

Key Customer Objections & Rebuttals

Objection	Rebuttal Strategy
'Is this real therapy or just an app?'	Highlight licensed, verified therapists with RCI/BACP credentials and reviews.
'What if my employer finds out?'	Zero-disclosure policy, anonymous onboarding, HIPAA/PDPB compliant data.
'I can just talk to a friend.'	Position as complementary — 'for when friends aren't enough.' Non-judgmental space.
'Too expensive even at INR 500.'	Offer free AI sessions, sliding-scale pricing, employer-subsidised access.
'AI can't understand emotions.'	Lead with human therapists. AI is the triage layer only — clarify during onboarding.

Key Buying Triggers

Trigger	Mechanism
Trigger Event	A panic attack, breakup, job loss, or burnout episode creates acute urgency.
Social Proof	Friend, influencer, or Reddit post mentions the platform — trust transfers instantly.
Free Assessment Hook	Validated, free anxiety/depression test with personalised result lowers entry barrier.
Privacy Guarantee	Reassurance data is never shared with employer/family removes the #1 objection.
Affordable First Session	Freemium or heavily discounted first session (INR 99 or free) converts fence-sitters.

07 MVP RECOMMENDATION

What Should Be Built First?

Build	Why
Free AI Psychometric Assessment	PHQ-9 / GAD-7 via conversational interface with scored, personalised output — the core hook.
Therapist Matching & Booking	Simple matching by specialty, language, availability. No complex algorithm needed at V1.
Intro Session (Free 20 min)	First therapist session free to reduce financial risk for the user. Converts trust to revenue.
Anonymous Onboarding	Email-only signup, no real name required — removes the #1 barrier for stigma-prone users.
Progress Tracking (Basic)	Session notes + mood check-in after each session. Simple, not algorithmic.

What Should NOT Be Built (V1)?

Do Not Build	Reason
Full AI Therapy / Chatbot	Wysa already does this and regulatory risk is high. Human therapists are the moat.
Community / Social Features	Moderation liability + distraction from core therapy flow. Add post-PMF.
Native iOS + Android Apps	Start with a PWA / responsive web app. Mobile app after 1,000 paying users.
Multilingual Support	Validate English-first; Hindi/Tamil language packs in Phase 2 after traction.
Corporate B2B Dashboard	B2B is Year 2. Don't build enterprise features before individual PMF is proven.

MVP Success Metrics

Metric	Target	Why It Matters
Waitlist Sign-ups	100+ signups in 30 days	Demand signal
Free Assessment Completion	60%+ of users complete the test	Engagement & product-market resonance
Intro Call Booking Rate	25%+ of assessment completers book	Conversion from awareness to action
Session-1 to Session-2 Retention	40%+ return for a second session	Early retention / therapy adherence
NPS Score	50+ after first paid session	Trust & word-of-mouth readiness
CAC vs LTV	LTV > 3x CAC by Month 6	Unit economics viability

08 MoSCoW PRIORITISATION

MUST HAVE

- Free AI psychometric assessments (PHQ-9, GAD-7) with scored output
- Licensed therapist profiles with credentials, languages, specialties
- Session booking (calendar + video/chat link)
- Anonymous / email-only onboarding with privacy guarantee
- Intro session free (20 min) — core conversion mechanic
- HIPAA / DPDP Act compliant data architecture
- Crisis escalation protocol (helpline integration for high-risk scores)

SHOULD HAVE

- Mood check-in + basic progress tracking after each session
- Therapist–user matching algorithm (specialty + language + rating)
- Tiered pricing (INR 299 / 599 / 999 per session)
- In-app secure messaging between sessions
- Session reminder notifications (push / SMS)

COULD HAVE

- Guided journaling / between-session exercises (CBT worksheets)
- Hindi / Tamil language assessment interface
- Referral programme (give 1 free session, get 1 free session)
- Basic analytics dashboard for users (session count, mood trends)
- Employer / corporate wellness landing page for early B2B leads

WON'T HAVE (V1)

- Native iOS / Android apps (PWA first)
- AI therapy chatbot / 24/7 AI emotional support (regulatory risk)
- Community forums or peer support groups
- Psychiatrist or medication management features
- Full B2B corporate HR dashboard

09 PRICING HYPOTHESIS

Tier	Price	Target ICP	Includes
Free Tier	Free forever	All users	Psychometric assessments (PHQ-9, GAD-7), AI score report, 1 free intro call (20 min)
Essential	INR 299 / \$4 per session	ICP A — Students	Unlimited booking, chat with therapist, basic progress tracking
Standard	INR 599 / \$8 per session	ICP B — Professionals	All Essential + video sessions, session notes, secure messaging
Premium	INR 999–1,499 / \$15 per session	ICP D — Diaspora	Senior therapists, language-matched, priority scheduling
Corporate B2B	INR 100–200/employee/month	ICP C — HR Leaders	Bulk session credits, anonymous utilisation reporting, onboarding support

Conversion Hypothesis: 8–12% free-to-paid in Months 1–6; B2B contracts from Month 12 onwards. Validate with real cohort data — do not optimise pricing before 500 active users.

10 TOP 5 RISKS

#	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Description	Mitigation
R 1	Regulatory / Legal	HIGH	HIGH	DPDP Act (India), HIPAA (USA), GDPR (EU). Practicing therapy without licensed oversight = legal liability.	Engage healthcare lawyer in Month 1. Build compliant data architecture from Day 1.
R 2	Clinical Liability	HIGH	HIGH	User self-harms or expresses suicidal ideation — platform failure is existential.	Build crisis escalation protocol + crisis hotline integration before any user onboarding.
R 3	Trust & Data Privacy	HIGH	MED	Mental health data is the most sensitive personal data. A breach destroys trust permanently.	ISO 27001-aligned architecture. Encrypt all data at rest + transit. No third-party ad data sharing.
R 4	Therapist Supply	MED	HIGH	Recruiting licensed, affordable therapists is a chicken-and-egg problem at early stage.	Onboard 5–10 therapists pre-launch via equity/revenue share. Build waitlist, not demand.
R 5	AI Misdiagnosis	MED	HIGH	AI psychometric tools must never replace clinical diagnosis. Misinterpretation risks delaying care.	All AI outputs carry disclaimer: 'Not a clinical diagnosis.' Human review for high-risk scores.

11 30-DAY MVP PLAN

Period	Focus	Key Actions
Week 1 Days 1–7	Research & Foundation	• Read 'The Mom Test' + YC startup resources • Contact 5 licensed clinical psychologists on LinkedIn (advisor / freelance) • Set up landing page (Carrd / Webflow) with email waitlist — target 50 sign-ups • Post 3 Reddit surveys (r/india, r/mentalhealth, r/Anxiety) — target 20 responses
Week 2 Days 8–14	Customer Discovery	• Conduct 10 user interviews (30 min each) — listen, don't pitch. Record + transcribe • Map top 3 competitors' UX flows; read 1-star App Store reviews for gaps • Identify 3 tech co-founders or healthcare app dev agencies — get NDA + cost estimates
Week 3 Days 15–21	Legal & Clinical Framework	• 1-hour paid call with healthcare / startup lawyer — min viable compliance for IN + USA • Research RCI licensing requirements; understand liability model for platform therapists • Create paper prototype of user onboarding + assessment flow; test with 5 people
Week 4 Days 22–30	Synthesis & Decision	• Compile all interview insights into 1-page Customer Insight Summary • Write Business Model Canvas — revenue streams, cost structure, key partners • Push landing page on social — target 100 waitlist sign-ups total • Decision: go full-time within 3 months? Apply to YC / Antler / Google for Startups India?

12 FOUNDER ACTION SHEET — TOP 10 NEXT ACTIONS

#	Action	Timeline	Why It Matters
1	Conduct 30 customer discovery interviews	Week 1–3	Before writing any code — validate every core assumption.
2	Engage healthcare lawyer	Week 1	DPDP Act (IN) + HIPAA (USA) + GDPR (EU) minimum viable compliance.
3	Recruit clinical advisory board	Week 1–4	1 licensed psychologist + 1 psychiatrist. Offer equity or advisory shares.
4	Build & launch waitlist landing page	Day 3–5	Simple Carrd/Webflow site. Target 100 sign-ups in 30 days.
5	Find a technical co-founder	Week 2–4	Healthcare-grade security is non-negotiable. This is not a no-code build.
6	Complete psychology fundamentals course	Month 1–2	Coursera / NIMHANS resources. Builds credibility + domain knowledge.
7	Map competitor UX + read 1-star reviews	Week 2	Find the exact friction points users hate in BetterHelp, Wysa, iCall.
8	Build crisis escalation protocol	Before launch	Integrate iCall / Vandrevale helpline. Define internal escalation SOP.
9	Design paper prototype of onboarding	Week 3	Test flow with 5 people before spending money on development.
10	Apply to accelerator programme	Day 25–30	YC (next batch), Antler India, Google for Startups India. Deadline awareness.

13 SCORES & FINAL VERDICT

Customer Clarity 78 /100 Strong ICP definition with 4 distinct segments and a rich primary persona.	Problem Severity 90 /100 Critical unmet need validated by WHO data, market research, and lived experience.	PMF Potential 72 /100 Large gap exists. Conditional on regulatory navigation and clinical credibility.	MVP Readiness 55 /100 Idea-stage. No code, no therapists, no legal framework yet. 30-day plan addresses this.
--	---	---	--

Weighted Evaluation Matrix

Criterion	Raw Score	Weight	Weighted Score
Problem Severity & Urgency	9.0/10	20%	1.80
Market Size & Growth	9.0/10	15%	1.35
Competitive Differentiation	7.0/10	15%	1.05
Founder-Market Fit	6.8/10	15%	1.02
Monetisation Clarity	6.0/10	10%	0.60
Technical Feasibility	7.0/10	10%	0.70
Regulatory Navigability	5.0/10	10%	0.50
Existing Validation	3.0/10	5%	0.15
TOTAL	—	100%	7.17 / 10

■ PROMISING BUT PARTIALLY VALIDATED

The opportunity is real, large, and structurally underserved. Founding motivation is authentic and market timing is near-perfect (post-pandemic awareness + AI maturity). However, this is a regulated, high-stakes domain. The path to launch requires clinical advisors, legal counsel, and a technically capable co-founder before meaningful capital is deployed. Complete the 30-day validation sprint — if waitlist traction and interview insights confirm demand, this upgrades to a Strong Demand Signal.

